

词汇: *thrill-seeking* 寻求刺激

- 1 Rollercoasters have been making stomachs **flip** for centuries. The earliest versions appeared in 17th-century Russia, where brave riders **slid** down giant ice-covered ramps. Modern steel rollercoasters transformed theme parks into **thrill-seeking** playgrounds. Today, they're bigger, faster and taller than ever. Millions of people **queue** for hours just to experience a few minutes of screaming, laughing and that heart-racing drop. But if you're anything like me, there comes a point when those rides stop feeling exciting and start feeling... slightly **regrettable**.
- 2 As children, rollercoasters seem almost impossible to **resist**. Part of the appeal is that **contrasting** mix of fear and excitement. According to BBC Science Focus, rollercoasters **trigger** the body's fight-or-flight response, releasing adrenaline, dopamine and **endorphins** that make the experience feel exciting and rewarding. Our brains quickly learn to associate that **rush** with fun, which is why so many children can't wait to jump back in the queue. The sense of achievement doesn't hurt either – finally being tall enough to ride the biggest coaster feels like a **rite of passage**, making us feel braver and probably way cooler at the time.
- 3 So why does that love affair often fade with age? Unfortunately, our bodies change. WanderWisdom explains that changes in the inner ear as we get older can make us more sensitive to motion, meaning rollercoasters that once felt thrilling may now leave us feeling **dizzy** or nauseous. Motion sickness happens when the brain receives **conflicting** signals from the eyes and inner ear, leading to dizziness, nausea and that feeling of **churning** in your tummy. Add **stiffer** joints, sore necks and a stronger awareness of risk, and it's hardly surprising that the rides we once **begged** to go on can suddenly feel more exhausting than **exhilarating**.
- 4 The good news is that you don't have to completely give up coasters. Dramamine recommends staying hydrated, avoiding heavy meals before riding and looking towards the **horizon** instead of down at the tracks. Choosing a seat towards the middle can also make the ride feel less **intense**. These simple changes may reduce motion sickness and help you to **rediscover** the fun of laughing and screaming along the way without feeling the need to **hurl** or **pass out** as often!

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

- a. Everyone loves rollercoasters when they're a kid.
- b. It's impossible for you to get over your dislike of rollercoasters.
- c. There are some things you can do to help make rollercoasters feel enjoyable.

二、 根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. The first rollercoasters were built from steel.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. According to the text, why do many children enjoy rollercoasters so much?
 - a. Their brains associate the rush of adrenaline with fun.
 - b. They are less likely to feel motion sickness than adults.
 - c. They enjoy waiting in long queues.
3. As people get older, changes to the inner ear can make rollercoasters feel more uncomfortable.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
4. Which of the following is NOT suggested as a way to reduce motion sickness?
 - a. Close your eyes throughout the ride.
 - b. Sit towards the middle of the ride.
 - c. Stay hydrated.
5. The writer says that adults should stop riding rollercoasters completely.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Have you ever felt like you might **1)** _____ while riding a rollercoaster as an adult? Though you might experience a slight **2)** _____, you're more likely as an adult to find rollercoasters **3)** _____. This could be because of how **4)** _____ our bodies become as we age, or that the changes in our ears make us feel **5)** _____ from the motion of the ride.

beg	contrasting	dizzy
pass out		regrettable
rush		stiff

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

flip	翻腾
slide	滑行
thrill-seeking	追求刺激的
queue	排队
regrettable	令人后悔的
resist	抵挡，抗拒
contrasting	截然不同的，形成对比的
trigger	引发，触发
endorphin	内啡肽
rush	强烈的刺激感，兴奋感
rite of passage	成长的必经阶段
dizzy	头晕目眩的
conflicting	相互矛盾的
churning	（胃里）翻腾的，反胃的
stiffer	更僵硬的
beg	恳求
exhilarating	令人兴奋的，令人振奋的
horizon	地平线
intense	剧烈的，强烈的
rediscover	重新找回，重新发现
hurl	呕吐
pass out	失去知觉，昏倒

答案

一、 为本文选择总结句。

c. There are some things you can do to help make rollercoasters feel enjoyable.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b. False.** *The earliest versions appeared in 17th-century Russia, where **brave riders slid down giant ice-covered ramps**.*
2. **a. Our brains quickly learn to associate that rush with fun,** *which is why so many children can't wait to jump straight back in the queue.*
3. **a. True. Changes to the inner ear as we get older can make us more sensitive to motion,** *meaning rollercoasters that once felt thrilling may now leave us feeling dizzy or nauseous.*
4. **a.** *The text recommends staying hydrated, avoiding heavy meals before riding and looking towards the horizon instead of down at the tracks. Choosing a seat towards the middle can also make the ride feel less intense. It does not recommend closing your eyes.*
5. **b. False.** *The good news is that **you don't have to completely give up coasters**.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Have you ever felt like you might **pass out** while riding a roller coaster as an adult? Though you might experience a slight **rush**, you're more likely as an adult to find rollercoasters **regrettable**. This could be because of how **stiff** our bodies become as we age, or that the changes in our ears make us feel **dizzy** from the motion of the ride.